

Smartphone chipsets have become the heart of modern personal computing. In 2025, Qualcomm pushed multi-core muscle, Apple doubled down on efficiency and responsiveness, and MediaTek delivered its most balanced SoC yet. After extensive benchmarking across performance, thermals, battery impact, AI capability and connectivity, here are the winners.

Zero1 Winner: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Elite

Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Elite takes the crown this year for one simple reason: it is the most capable all-round performance SoC available today. Built around custom Oryon cores, the 8 Elite pushes multi-core workloads into laptop territory. Whether it was rendering long 4K edits or juggling multiple high-load apps, this chip stayed consistently smooth.

Where Qualcomm pulls ahead is connectivity. The X80 modem and advanced Wi-Fi 7 stack delivered the fastest and most stable wireless performance among all mobile platforms, and offers versatile features like lossless Bluetooth audio (aptX Lossless), faster charging standards, and wider support for high-refresh external displays.

Smartphone SoC

Fuelling the future of mobile computing for all



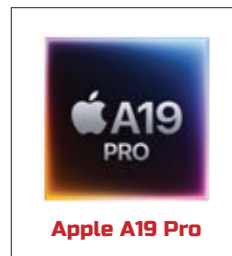
MediaTek Dimensity 9400 Plus

If your day spans productivity, gaming, content creation and heavy wireless use, the Snapdragon 8 Elite simply feels more complete.

Runner-up: Apple A19 Pro

The A19 Pro continues Apple's dominance in single-core latency, which directly impacts how quickly apps launch, how snappy animations feel, and how fluid everyday navigation is. For typical smartphone use, this responsiveness remains unmatched.

The A19 Pro is also the most power-efficient chip under light to moderate workloads. Browsing, messaging, social media, and even short camera sessions sip battery instead of draining it. Apple's ISP continues to lead in video performance, making it the gold standard for mobile content creators.



Apple A19 Pro

The Neural Engine also remains incredibly efficient for background AI tasks like photo sorting, health metrics, and Siri suggestions. In terms of overall polish, the A19 Pro sets the bar for day-to-day smartphone experience, but falls just short of Qualcomm in raw versatility and multi-core strength.

Best Buy: MediaTek Dimensity 9400 Plus

The Dimensity 9400 Plus delivers performance that, in regular apps, often feels indistinguishable from the Snapdragon 8 Elite and A19 Pro. Where it stands out is efficiency. MediaTek's big-core architecture has proven incredibly effective, giving it some of the best real-world battery numbers this year.

The 9400 Plus also runs cooler during long GPS sessions, extended video calls, and heavy messaging days. For gaming, it performs admirably, but its real advantage lies in its comfort and consistency during everyday use. Factor in the pricing, and it becomes a clear value champion.

— Siddharth Chauhan | editor@digit.in